

GURUS GET IT ALL WRONG

It governs the fate of 8,000 teacher training colleges in the country, but its status as a cash cow has turned the National Council for Teacher Education into a breeding ground of corruption

■ By Shruti Maheshwari

Nobody knows for sure since when has the Islamia Teachers' Training College, Patna, been functioning. Two teams that visited the institution differ on the year of establishment. One puts it as 1984 while the other says it's 1986. However, the list of teachers supplied by the institution shows that of the 15 teachers listed, 14 had joined it only in 1997. This institution was granted recognition, from year to year, under very unusual circumstances, as an 'existing' institution for 1997-98 and 1998-99.

This, as the Anand Sarup Committee-2000—set up by the Ministry of Human Resource Development (MHRD) to look into the cases of proliferation of fake B.Ed shops in Bihar—discovered, was only the tip of the iceberg. Nothing much



TO BE OR NOT TO BE: Banerjee report proposes scrapping of NCTE

has happened on the explosive findings of the report and it was eventually scuttled because of political pressures.

Seven years on, teacher education in the country has come to be infested with such systemic rot that the Sudip Banerjee report, submitted to the MHRD, has recommended scrapping of the National Council for Teacher Education (NCTE)—the apex body accountable for a situation where undeserving institutes were granted recognition, sometimes without the mandatory inspection.

Formed in 1995 under an Act of Parliament to regulate teacher education in the country, NCTE has approximately 8,000 teacher education colleges under its purview, which offer courses for teachers from pre-school to secondary level. Intended to do away with the malaise of distance learning programmes that were being run by private players as well as pli-

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THE NCTE REPORT CARD

1. Allowed unchecked proliferation of teaching shops across the country: **Colleges total 8,000**
2. **Granted affiliation** to colleges irrespective of demand for teachers in that state
3. Offered no standardisation of teachers' qualifications: **total courses recognised are 7,567**
4. Concentrated more on infrastructure rather than teaching processes and curriculum in its **12 years** of existence
5. **Gave affiliation** to more B.Ed colleges than necessary and neglected primary education
6. Processed applications **out of order**

Rs 40,000 is charged per applicant and yet there is no system of budgetary controls. Crores of rupees lay unused in current accounts.